

Art: Textile Design

(A Level, AQA)

This course introduces you to a variety of experiences that explore a range of textiles processes and techniques, both old and new. Throughout the first year, you will experience a number of workshops that aim to develop your skills and give you a sound core knowledge of textiles processes that will be used in your course work. You will learn printing techniques, pattern and surface decoration that will enable you to design and produce your own fabrics leading on to pattern drafting and the construction of garments.

During the second year, you will be able to choose the direction you want to take your work in, both contextually and through the choice of media. You will cover a wide range of modern and traditional techniques and skills with a focus on fashion and interiors.

Entry Requirements:

GCSE Grade 4 in Art or Art Textiles. If you have not taken Art or Textiles GCSE you will be expected to show work of the expected level before coming to the induction session and starting the course.

Course Content

Unit	%	When?	Content
Component 1: Personal Investigation	60%	September to December (Year 1)	Experiences: You will be taught a wide range of construction skills, including pattern drafting, mannequin draping and basic tailoring. You will explore techniques using a variety of different media and fabrics that all relate to significant experiences in your life. You will make a garment of your choice as a result of your experiments and research.
		January (Year 1) to January (Year 2)	Personal Investigation: your choice of theme Inspiration Book – finding inspiration - learning how to research, analyse and respond to photographers and artists. Responding and experimenting with ideas – developing skills. Further experimentation of a wide range of techniques building on the skills acquired in the first project including pattern drafting and garment construction. Essay – 1000-3000 word essay that makes links with your own textiles work and shows critical and contextual understanding. Practical project resulting in final outcomes – you will start the main project in September of Year 2.
Component 2: Externally Set Assignment	40%	February to May (Year 2)	Choose from eight given starting points from the exam board. Preparation work over three months to develop ideas. Fifteen hours (three days) of supervised sessions to complete your final outcomes. All work is assessed as a whole project for final grade.

Career Links

Students who have done Textiles frequently go on to degree courses via an Art Foundation course and have ended up enjoying a wide range of related careers such as Textiles and Fashion Design in Industry, (this can include a wide range of high street and designer fashion houses) Fashion Journalism, Interior Design, Fashion buying and selling, Marketing, Branding, Environmental development of new fibres, Sportswear technology and design and many more. The Textiles industry is the biggest in Britain.

For more information please contact Ms S Walton